The Juilliard School
presents

Celebrating Philip Glass

Curated by Derek Wang,
Juilliard Creative Enterprise Fellow

January 29 and 30, 2026
Juilliard Station

Celebrating Philip Glass
Samuel Beckett's *Company*

Friday, January 30, 2026, 6pm
Juilliard Station

Excerpts from Samuel Beckett's novella *Company* (1979)
Jake Horowitz (Group 52, drama), Speaker

PHILIP GLASS
(b. 1937)

String Quartet No. 2, "Company" (1983)

Candide Quartet
Chili Ekman (BM '26), Violin
Henry Rogers (BM '25, MM '27), Violin
Amelia Krinke (Pre-College '22; BM '26), Viola
Vanny Hu (BM '26), Cello

Epilogue for Solo Violin (1997)
Chili Ekman, Violin

A Note from Derek Wang, Curator

The "Philip Glass sound" is something we know and love—and, this week, celebrate. But it is also more slippery than we might at first think. It is easy to describe the notes but nearly impossible to paraphrase their effect. It is more than the sum of its parts, and always about that "more." It consists of familiar musical materials, but never fails to lend mystery and otherworldliness to what we see onstage, onscreen, or—looking out onto Broadway from Juilliard Station—in life.

These evenings grow from a question and separate (though not unrelated) answer. The question Glass posed in his student years: "Where does music come from?" Thursday's performance installation invites us to listen behind the notes, tracking shifts not only in what we hear but in what we think we hear. Friday's pairing of text and music follows Samuel Beckett's advice, given in answer to Glass as he scored a staged version of the novella *Company*: "The music should go into the interstices of the text, as it were."

"Into the interstices" we go, then, listening between the lines as we celebrate this most distinguished of Juilliard alumni in our age, whose music and life continue to set an example for all of us in their combination of rigor and openness, plan and surprise.

About Philip Glass

Through his operas, his symphonies, his compositions for his own ensemble, and his wide-ranging collaborations, Philip Glass (Diploma '60, MS '62, composition) has had an extraordinary and unprecedented impact upon the musical and intellectual life of his times. The operas—*Einstein on the Beach*, *Satyagraha*, *Akhnaten*, and *The Voyage*, among many others—play in the world's leading houses, rarely to an empty seat. Glass has written music for experimental theater and for Oscar-winning motion pictures such as *The Hour*s and Martin Scorsese's *Kundun*, while *Koyaanisqatsi*—his initial filmic landscape with Godfrey Reggio and the Philip Glass Ensemble—may be the most radical and influential mating of sound and vision since *Fantasia*. His associations, personal and professional, with leading rock, pop, and world music artists date back to the 1960s, including the beginning of his collaborative relationship with artist Robert Wilson. Indeed, Glass is the first composer to win a wide, multi-generational audience in the opera house, the concert hall, the dance world, in film, and in popular music—simultaneously.

Glass was born in 1937 and grew up in Baltimore. He studied at the University of Chicago and Juilliard as well as in Aspen with Darius Milhaud. Finding himself dissatisfied with much of what then passed for modern music, Glass moved to Europe, where he studied with the legendary pedagogue Nadia Boulanger (who also taught Aaron Copland , Virgil Thomson, and Quincy Jones) and worked closely with the sitar virtuoso and composer Ravi Shankar. Glass returned to New York in 1967 and formed the Philip Glass Ensemble—seven musicians playing keyboards and a variety of woodwinds, amplified and fed through a mixer. The new musical style that Glass was evolving was eventually dubbed "minimalism." Glass himself never liked the term and preferred to speak of himself as a composer of "music with repetitive structures." Much of his early work was based on the extended reiteration of brief, elegant melodic fragments that wove in and out of an aural tapestry. Or, to put it another way, it immersed a listener in a sort of sonic weather that twists, turns, surrounds, develops. There has been nothing "minimalist" about his output. Glass has composed more than 30 operas, large and small; 14 symphonies; 13 concertos; soundtracks to films ranging from new scores for the stylized classics of Jean Cocteau to the Errol Morris documentaries *The Thin Blue Line* and *The Fog of War*; 9 string quartets; and a growing body of work for solo piano and organ. He has collaborated with Allen Ginsberg, David Bowie, Paul Simon, Linda Ronstadt, Yo-Yo Ma, Leonard Cohen, and Doris Lessing, among many others.

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